LESSON 9: ORGANIZATION OF EDUCATIONAL PLANNING

9.1 Introduction

Organizations or institutions defers in structure system and orientation in terms of providing education. Centralized planning or macro planning of education refers to long strategic planning by a national agent/authority where educational plans, policies, goals and objectives are formulated and communicated to the lower levels.

9.1 Lesson learning objectives

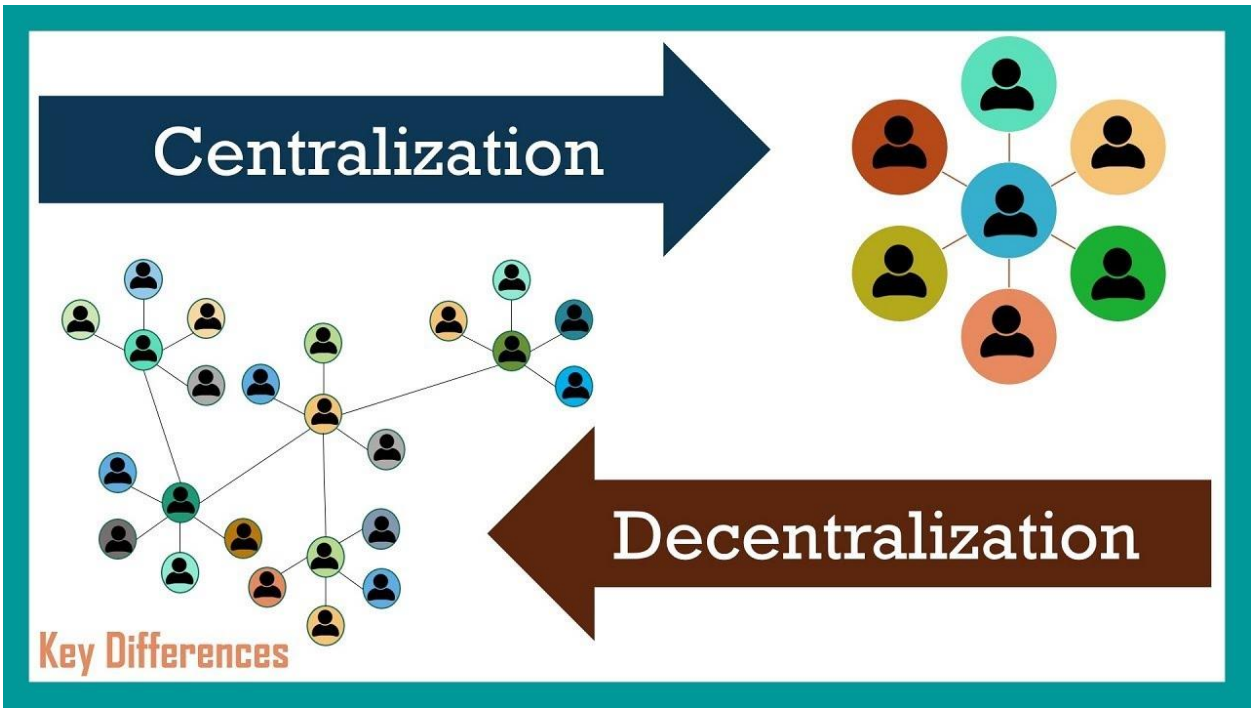
By the end of the lesson, learners should be able to

9.1.1 Describe centralized educational planning

9.1.2 Describe decentralized educational planning

9.1.3 Explain the stages in the process of educational planning

Centralized versus decentralized



9.1.1 Centralized educational planning

The concepts of centralization and decentralization are important ones to consider as they ultimately affect the effectiveness of schools in educating the children of a nation. Centralization refers to the condition whereby the administrative authority for education is vested, not in the local community, but in a central body. This central body has complete power over all resources: money, information, people, technology.

In the centralized structure, reforms are initiated by central administration. It usually originates at the top and finds its way to the bottom. The top decides the content of curriculum, controls the budget, is responsible for employment, the building of educational facilities, discipline policies, etc.

In Kenya, public education is under the total control of a central administration headed by the cabinet secretary. It is virtually impossible to manage large and complex organizations from the top. Inflated bureaucracies are extremely slow to respond to local needs and are not very adaptable. Centralization does not fit the current trends of participatory management, empowerment, and shared decision-making.

Centralized educational planning, can be reflected in areas such as:

- Curriculum planning
- Implementation
- Evaluation
- Formulation of national goals and objectives of education.
- Formulation of national educational policies and design of educational plans
- Financing of education
- Administration and management of education

Advantages of Centralized educational planning

9.1.2 Decentralization educational planning

Decentralization, on the other hand, refers to the extent to which authority has been passed down to the individual school. Site-based management is an example of decentralization in which individual schools can make their own decisions related to finances and curriculum. However, the locus of power remains with the central body. Advocates of decentralization believe it will result in higher student performance; more efficient use of resources; increased skills and satisfaction for school administrators and teachers; and greater community and business involvement in and support for schools.

Decentralization provides local administrators with greater autonomy, thus giving scope for creativity, resourcefulness, and personal enhancement particularly in the area of problem solving.

Decentralization provides for persons at the scene of the action to become involved in the decision-making process. This allows for greater flexibility, and makes it possible for better decisions to be made because persons at the scene of the action are more closely related to the problem.

When individual schools are given the opportunity to make decisions, a higher degree of morale and commitment to the organizational goals and objectives are fostered. If the principal through decentralization is given the authority to generate and disburse funds, great gains could be realized. The staff, then, would exert more effort since it would be a means by which their strategic plans for curricula and program development could be implemented.

Decentralization also promotes the professional development of principals. Everyone has the innate tendency towards self-actualization. Therefore, being responsible for the development of school goals and objectives and their implementation would encourage principals to seek various means for achieving professional growth while maximizing their potentials.

Decentralization demands the establishment of accountability and evaluation mechanisms. This in itself would ensure that individual schools operate at a high level of efficiency and effectiveness in promoting student achievement.

Decentralization promotes greater parental and community involvement. Community members and parents can provide valuable insight about how schools can be improved to better educate the children in the community. Parents having a greater stake in the educational process, would have a better understanding of the problems facing schools, and would tend to increase their support.

9.1.3 Stages in the process of educational planning

There are five main stages of educational planning:

(1) Collection and Analysis of Statistical Information:

At this stage, relevant information about the system of education and concerned socio-economic factors is collected so as to provide the quantitative basis for projections aimed at the future development of the educational system. Along with this, assessment in some allied fields is also necessary as education is an integral part of the total plan and is closely inter-related with the economic development of the country.

(2) Evolving Policy Proposals:

The statistical information collected helps in identifying the gaps, weaknesses and shortcoming and provides the planners with a clear idea of the existing conditions. This helps the planners in formulating policy proposals aimed at accomplishing pre-determined objectives. The formulation of the policy proposal requires an over-all view of the role of education vis-a-vis the economic development and the over-all planning. It should also take into account the complexities of a large country like India, the diversities of cultures within it as well as the regional aspirations.

These necessitate the introduction of a uniform educational system (e.g., 8-4-4 system or the current CBC system) along with scope for regional diversities in the curricula. It should also aim at evolving policy decisions concerning rational norms of optimum class-size in terms of enrollment and student-teacher ratios at different levels and types of education.

Besides, policies concerning admission criteria (except the compulsory primary education level), promotion of students, fees to be paid on the basis of the principle of social justice, supply of text-books, equipment, devising curricula, methods of teaching, teachers' qualifications and in-service professional development, methods of evaluation, medium of instruction, language policy and teachers' salaries must be taken into account.

(3) Projections, Programming and Project Analysis:

An effective plan necessitates projections of all the inputs of the educational system – students, teachers, administrators, school buildings and classrooms, equipment and financial requirements. Projections have to be made of the future nature and size of the demographic composition of population for a period of fifteen to twenty years. Since student is the focus of the educational process, projection should begin with the school and the college age-groups drawn on a yearly basis in terms of enrolments.

There are two commonly employed procedures available for scientific projections:

*(i)*The enrolment ratio method which is based on the projection of past and present ratios of school enrolment or school attendance into the future. It requires estimates of population by age and sex regarding school enrolment and/or attendance data.

*(ii)*The grade cohort method which is also known as cohort survival method. This method also makes use of the past and current enrolment data by grade for every school level and for approximately seven-year and ten-year data for primary and secondary levels respectively.
It also requires data on the number of new students, repeaters and those who pass on to the next higher class for every standard/class. Projections are calculated from the survival rates of students after taking into consideration demographic characteristics such as birth rate, mortality rate and migration rates.

Along with this, a minimum social standard of education needs to be postulated such as compulsory schooling for every child for a certain number of years. This is followed by programming and operation. For example, if 800 technicians are to be produced, a programme on the number of institutions, teachers, equipments, space, syllabi, courses, etc., is to be worked out. Here, one institution is called a project programming and project analysis involves the application of administrative and economic principles in order to assess a particular situation and establish an operational programme.

(4) Costing Educational Plans:

Education is an activity wherein the institution and the society bear part of the cost and the learner bears part of the cost. In order to improve the formulation and implementation of educational plans, it is necessary to understand the methods of costing education and the problems associated with it. The unit costs of different types of educational facilities need to be computed. These costs are to be studied in terms of the availability of present and future financial resources. It should be ensured at this stage that the real cost of education is not too high so as to be inconsistent with the attainment of the overall plan objectives.

(5) Decision, Implementation and Evaluation:

A five year plan needs to be broken up into annual plans. Each annual plan is scrutinized, discussed and criticized in relation to a review of previous year's strengths, weaknesses and achievements. At this stage, the necessary conditions for effective implementation of the programme need to be created. Thereafter, the actual operations take place. At the end of the plan, evaluation is done in terms of the extent to which the objectives of the plan have been accomplished in an effective and efficient manner.

READ Demographic Aspects of Educational Planning (attached)

http://www.educationforallinindia.com/use-of-demographic-modules-in-education.htm